

Werewolf: whole-class game routine

Use your physical Ultimate Werewolf deck for 25 student players plus the teacher moderator. The proposed mixed-role selection is on the deck page. Confirm the cards and exact abilities before play.

Read both rules pages and the narrator script before playing.

Choose and explain the deck

Use the 25-player setup with your physical Ultimate Werewolf cards. The teacher moderates so all 25 students receive a role. Before dealing, explain every selected role and agree on the night order, role-reveal policy and time limit. Keep secret assignments off the projector. The illustrated nine-card sheet is a three-role demonstration only.

Night: use the selected role order

Everyone closes their eyes and responds only to their role's cue. The moderator follows the first-night or later-night order prepared from the actual rulebook. Resolve protection, wolf choices, other abilities and triggered changes before announcing the outcome. The short wolves-then-Seer demonstration is not the full night order for a mixed deck.

Day: announce resolved events

Everyone opens their eyes. Announce only the final public outcome: there may be no departures, one or more. Complete triggered actions such as the Hunter's before checking a winner. Departed players become quiet story trackers after any permitted role action. Keep their cards hidden unless the selected card requires a reveal; agree on these classroom adaptations before play.

Werewolf: discussion and endings

Discuss and vote

Use 3–4 minutes for discussion. Take turns, ask for reasons and allow a response. A role claim is not proof. For our classroom vote, every active player simultaneously points to one other active player. Highest vote selects that player; a top tie selects nobody. Apply the selected role's protection or triggered action before confirming departures. Discuss game events, not friendships or personalities.

Check the ending

For the suggested two-team selection, check after all immediate effects finish: no active wolves means the village wins; wolves equal to or outnumbering all other active players means the wolves win. Count special village roles with the village. Follow the selected card rules for pending abilities. Agree on a 25–35 minute play window; a whole-class game may not finish. At time, finish the action and otherwise close without a winner.

Retell and change roles

Story trackers record public events silently; they do not advise, signal or vote unless their selected role explicitly allows an action. The moderator keeps hidden departed-role cues consistent so silence does not disclose information. At the end, reveal roles and include everyone in retelling and feedback. Re-deal for the next game. Learn unfamiliar expansion roles before adding them.

Narrator script

Use clear everyday speech for directions. Add brief atmosphere between actions; never invent evidence about a player.

Prepare the moderator sheet

Privately record all 25 player numbers and roles. From the selected cards and your edition's rulebook, write the first-night order, later-night order, action limits and departure triggers. Explain those rules publicly without identifying anyone's secret card. Say: "Act only when your role is called."

Close the village and call roles

"Night falls. Everyone, close your eyes." Follow your prepared order, including first-night recognition roles. For each: "[Role], open your eyes. [Exact allowed choice.]" Confirm the choice privately, then say: "[Role], close your eyes." Keep used or departed-role cues consistent when their status is hidden.

Resolve before morning

Privately apply protection and other abilities in the rulebook's order. Record used abilities and any newly active role. In a three-role demonstration only: wolves choose a non-wolf player, then the Seer checks another player; thumbs up means wolf, thumbs down means not wolf. Add every selected role's cue for real play.

Open the day

"Morning comes. Everyone, open your eyes." Announce the resolved departures, or "Everyone remains in the village." Complete any triggered card action and update your record before checking for a winner. Invite departed players to track public story events quietly; reveal a card only when the agreed rules require it.

Host discussion and vote

"We have three to four minutes. What changed your thinking? Who has a different explanation?" Invite responses and quieter voices. "Three, two, one, point." Count votes accurately. Announce the selected player or the top tie. Apply role exceptions before announcing who leaves.

Close or continue

Update roles and active players after all immediate effects. Check the agreed win conditions. Begin another night or announce the actual ending. At the time limit, finish the current action; if neither team has won, say so. Reveal cards only once play has ended. Everyone retells, receives feedback and revises.

Private narrator record

Keep this page off the projector and hidden from players. Check each card privately before starting. Resolve immediate role effects, then mark removals and check the win conditions.

Player number	Secret role	Active / story tracker
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
11		
12		
13		
14		
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24		
25		

Check the two-team endings after immediate role effects: village wins with no active wolves; wolves win at parity or greater. Follow the selected card rules for pending abilities. At time, finish the action and otherwise close without a winner.

Storyteller cue planner

Name: _____ Date: _____

Choose a forest, mountain or island village. Plan an original story opening. Use cue words to remember your ideas.

Setting: where are we? Add one sound or movement.

Change: what interrupts the ordinary moment?

Question: what will the listener want to know?

Three to five cue words to guide your telling.

Voice: mark a pause, a pace change or a word to emphasize.

Narrator rehearsal: add cues for night, morning and two endings (a team wins / time runs out). Keep the exact narrator script beside you.

Listen, retell and revise

Name: _____ Date: _____

Tell your partner a short scene or retell public game events. Listen to their feedback, change one part and tell it again.

My speaking goal:

Story order: first ... then ... finally ...

One clear moment I heard:

One question I asked my partner:

Feedback I received:

The part I changed and how it helped:

25-player setup: your physical deck

Suggested selection for 25 student players plus the teacher as neutral moderator: 12 plain Villagers and 13 other roles. Use your physical Ultimate Werewolf deck. These are candidate cards, not a confirmed inventory or a tested balance. Check your edition's cards, rules and balance guidance before dealing. If a named card is absent, choose a familiar village-team replacement and teach its rule; keep exactly one card per player. With one of 25 students narrating, deal 24 cards by removing one Villager.

Candidate role	Qty	Explain before play
Werewolf	5	Explain the shared night choice and the wolf team goal.
Seer	1	Explain the private question and what the answer does and does not reveal.
Bodyguard	1	Read who can be protected, what protection stops and any repeat-target restriction.
Witch	1	Read each ability, its use limit and when the narrator asks for a choice.
Hunter	1	Read the departure trigger and resolve the resulting action before checking a winner.
Mason	2	Read how the pair recognises each other and any restrictions on sharing that information.
Prince	1	Read what happens when the vote selects this role and whether that protection has a limit.
Apprentice Seer	1	Read when the role becomes active and how the moderator privately signals the change.
Villager	12	Listen, question, compare claims and vote. No night action does not mean no part in the story.

Total: 25 student players. The teacher moderates separately.

Learn roles before dealing

Before this week: lay out the selected physical cards. Confirm each role's team, action, timing, limits and win condition from your edition. Write a first-night order and a later-night order on the moderator sheet; include departures and triggered abilities. Announce any classroom adaptations before dealing.

Teach before hiding: partners each explain a selected role using "My team is __. I act when __. I can __, but I cannot __." Share all role explanations. Demonstrate a protected night target, a vote that selects the Prince and a Hunter departure using the actual card rules. Repair misunderstandings before shuffling.

Later games: choose one unfamiliar role at a time. Read its card, explain it in everyday language, model one legal move and one non-example, and rehearse the new narrator cue. Replace a card rather than adding an extra player; reconsider team balance and endings if the role changes them.

After play: note whether nights were manageable and both teams had meaningful choices. Adjust the next selection using the edition's balance guidance and class experience. Change roles between games, never halfway through a game without a role rule that requires it.

Moderator preparation

First-night role order:

Later-night role order:

Limited abilities and departure triggers:

Role reference: Ultimate Edition rules, rulespal.com/ultimate-werewolf-ultimate-edition/rulebook. Use your physical edition for exact abilities. Original classroom teaching mix; not yet play-tested.

Werewolf 1 · Learn the game

Explain the roles and follow night, day, discussion and voting.

Finish with: A spoken explanation of one role and the order of a complete round.

Meet the roles | 12 min

Open the 25-player setup. Lay out the selected physical cards. First explain Villager, Werewolf and Seer; then partners prepare and share the other role explanations using the cards. Say each role's team, action, timing and limit. The teacher is the neutral moderator.

Model: "I am a Villager. I sleep at night. During the day, I listen, discuss and vote. My team tries to find every werewolf."

Check: Both partners can explain a role and say which team it belongs to.

Watch an open demonstration | 15 min

Use face-up cards for a short three-role demonstration, then rehearse the selected special roles with the whole class. Try a protected target, a Prince vote and a Hunter departure using your actual cards. Name who acts next. This is open rehearsal; shuffle before hidden-role play.

Model: Example only: players 1 and 2 are wolves, 3 is the Seer, and 4–9 are villagers. Wolves choose 9. Seer asks about 1 and receives thumbs up. At daybreak, 9 becomes a story tracker. The remaining players discuss and vote.

Check: You can explain why player 9 does not vote and why the Seer receives a private answer.

Rehearse the order | 12 min

Close or hide the script. With a partner, say the prepared role order from dealing cards to checking a winner. Swap speakers. Reopen Rules to repair any missed step. Try a tied-vote example together.

Check: Your explanation includes night actions, day result, discussion, simultaneous vote and a winner check.

Explain before playing | 6 min

Each person explains one role and the next action after a tied vote. Answer the check question below before revealing the explanation.

Check: You can follow the rules without relying on a captain to decide what happens.

Think and explain

Two wolves and two other active players remain, with no pending role effects. What happens? What if two players tie for the highest vote?

Werewolf 2 · Practise playing and listening

Follow a hidden-role game and separate a claim from a known event.

Finish with: A short public-event retelling and one question that helped discussion.

Practise useful discussion | 6 min

Read the example. With a partner, replace a comment about someone's personality with a question about this game. Agree that quietness, eye contact and friendships do not prove a role.

Model: Instead of "You always lie," try "Earlier you suggested player 2. What made you change your vote to player 5?" A reply can be "I changed my mind because __. I am still unsure about __."

Check: Your question names a game statement or action and gives someone room to reply.

Play as a whole class | 25 min

Deal one physical role card to each student. Use the prepared mixed-role night order, 3–4 minute daytime discussions and a 25-minute play window. Finish the current action at time; if neither team has won, close without a winner. If you leave active play, silently jot or sketch public events. Keep secret information to yourself until the game ends.

Check: The narrator follows the order; players wait their turns and vote together.

Retell what happened | 10 min

When play ends, reveal roles. In pairs, each person gives a 30-second retelling: first, then, finally. Include one public statement that changed your thinking and label a guess as a guess. Story trackers share their notes now.

Model: "First, player 9 left. Then someone claimed to be the Seer. I believed the claim, but it was not confirmed. Finally, our vote was tied."

Check: Your partner can separate an event, a claim and your interpretation.

Repair one habit | 9 min

Answer the check question. Then rehearse a 30-second discussion with a partner, using one clearer question or a better turn-taking habit. Save that goal for the next game.

Check: Name an actual listening move you will try; winning is not the learning check.

Think and explain

"Player 4 says they are the Seer." Is that proof? How could you ask for useful information?

Werewolf 3 · Build a story worth hearing

Create a setting, a change and an unanswered question using precise details.

Finish with: An original 45–60 second opening, three cue words and a revised telling.

Hear a story opening | 7 min

Listen to the model read aloud. Name the setting, what changes and the unanswered question. Explain which detail helped you picture the place.

Model: “At dusk, rain tapped the village roofs. One lantern glowed beside the bridge. Suddenly, the bell rang once, then fell silent. The villagers gathered in the square. What would the morning bring?”

Check: You can identify a place, a change and a question without inventing a suspect.

Plan three story beats | 10 min

Choose a forest village, mountain village or island village. On the cue planner, write a setting, a change and a question. Add one sound or movement. Underline three cue words to help you remember.

Model: Setting: a windy island square. Change: the lighthouse beam goes dark. Question: what will the village discover at dawn? Cue words: wind / light / dawn.

Check: The change grows from the setting and does not give a player an invented clue.

Tell from cues | 15 min

Partner A tells for 45–60 seconds using cue words rather than reading sentences. Partner B retells the three beats and asks one clarity question. Swap roles. Allow a quiet partner audience or extra rehearsal time.

Check: Everyone tells and listens; a partner can follow the events in order.

Revise and tell again | 8 min

Change one confusing detail and retell the revised part. Answer the check question. Mark which words changed and explain how the change helped the listener.

Check: Your revision responds to feedback and keeps the story coherent.

Think and explain

Which is fair atmosphere during a game: “Rain rattled the roof” or “Player 4’s muddy boots prove they are a wolf”? Why?

Werewolf 4 · Practise voice, pace and pauses

Use vocal expression and gesture to guide a listener without shouting.

Finish with: Two tellings of the same short scene and feedback about a deliberate voice choice.

Hear the difference | 7 min

Listen as the teacher tells the same model once at an even pace and again with a pause at each slash. Say which version makes the change easier to follow.

Model: “The village settled for the night. / A bell rang. / Once. / Then silence. The lantern keeper turned towards the square.”

Check: Name the exact pause or change in pace and its effect.

Mark your voice choices | 8 min

Take your opening from Lesson 3, or use today’s model. Mark one slash for a pause, underline one word for emphasis and choose one small gesture. Keep instructions in your clear everyday voice.

Check: You know why each voice or gesture choice belongs in that moment.

Rehearse twice | 17 min

In pairs, tell your opening for 45–60 seconds, or use 15–20 seconds for today’s shorter model. Your listener names a clear moment and a moment that was hard to follow. Change one choice and tell again. Swap so both people practise twice.

Model: Feedback: “Your pause after ‘once’ made me wait for the next sound. The last sentence was rushed; leave time for me to picture the square.”

Check: Your second telling makes a deliberate improvement that your listener can describe.

Explain your craft | 8 min

Answer the check question. Each person demonstrates 15–20 seconds and explains one choice: “I paused at __ so the listener could __.” Keep the note with your cues.

Check: Explain the effect on the listener, not just that the voice sounded dramatic.

Think and explain

What makes a pause useful? How is it different from simply speaking more slowly throughout?

Werewolf 5 · Rehearse as narrator

Join clear game directions with atmosphere while keeping events accurate.

Finish with: A rehearsed opening, night-to-day transition and ending using a narrator cue sheet.

Separate story from directions | 7 min

Hear the model. Point out the story sentence and the exact game instruction. Read the Narrator script to learn what must stay accurate.

Model: Story: "Clouds covered the moon." Direction: "Everyone, close your eyes." Story: "Morning light reached the square." Direction: "Player 9 has left the village and is now a story tracker."

Check: A listener knows when to imagine and when to act.

Make a narrator cue sheet | 10 min

Use the cue planner. Add an opening, the night cues, a morning transition and two possible endings: a team wins, or time runs out. Keep the selected physical cards and prepared role order beside the printed script for exact instructions.

Check: Your plan includes both possible endings and does not predict the winner.

Rehearse fixed events | 17 min

In trios, rehearse these fictional events: wolves choose player 9; the Seer checks player 1, a wolf; at daybreak 9 leaves; the daytime vote is tied. No side has won and time then runs out. The host manages a brief pretend discussion; the listener checks the order. Rotate jobs after each four-minute rehearsal.

Check: Each person narrates once. Keep the Seer answer private within the pretend night and announce the tie accurately.

Repair a transition | 6 min

Use listener feedback to repeat one unclear instruction or transition. Answer the check question. Explain what stayed fixed and what you could improvise.

Check: You improve clarity without adding a false clue or changing a result.

Think and explain

The real vote is tied. Your planned ending says the village discovers a wolf. What should you say?

Werewolf 6 · Host, retell and improve

Apply storytelling and listening skills in a game, then show individual growth.

Finish with: A short hosted game plus each student's 45–60 second retelling and one revised passage.

Set one speaking goal | 5 min

Choose clear order, pace, pauses or expression. Share your goal with a partner. The narrator and host check the script, cards and timer; every person prepares to retell afterwards.

Check: Everyone has a speaking goal, including people who are not narrating the game.

Host the class game | 25 min

Use the selected deck, its prepared night order and a 25-minute play window. Resolve special-role effects before announcing results. At time, finish the current action and close without a winner if needed. The narrator gives a brief original opening and accurate transitions. The host invites different voices. Story trackers record public events quietly. At the end, reveal roles and thank the group.

Check: The story follows the game; directions remain clear and discussion stays about fictional roles.

Everyone tells | 12 min

In pairs, each person gives a 45–60 second retelling from three to five cue words. Name the beginning, a change and the actual ending. Use your chosen voice skill. Your partner names one effective moment and asks one question.

Check: Every student produces their own oral evidence, whether they played, narrated or tracked.

Revise and reflect | 13 min

Retell 20 seconds with one improvement. On the listener sheet, note your goal, the feedback and the change. Answer the check question. Compare with an earlier cue sheet; keep most work in class.

Check: You can demonstrate and explain one improvement. An occasional chosen example can join an existing SpacesEDU reflection.

Think and explain

What evidence shows that your storytelling improved, even if your team did not win?